

HENRY MELLER

# Meller Finds His Career-Best Round

A first visit to Catalonia produced the best net score of the day and a personal best on both measures for a player who had been last in the field just twenty-four hours earlier.

Henry Meller came to Costa Brava for round two occupying last place in the 2013 TEG Wooden Spoon race. An opening round of +7 net vs par had put him there. He showed no early urgency about leaving. The third brought a double bogey. The par-5 fourth brought a triple. The fifth brought another double. Seven shots in three holes, and a further slide down the Spoon standings.

Then, without warning, the golf changed. From the 9th to the 12th he gained five shots against net par and dropped not one gross

shot. The 12th, one of the hardest holes on the course, yielded a net eagle. He signed for -5 net vs par and +17 gross. Both were personal bests. The swing from his opening effort was 12 shots.

It was the best gross round recorded by anyone in the field that day. His net score was also the weakest of the round. Both things are true, and neither has the decency to cancel the other. The turnaround lifted him off the bottom of the Wooden Spoon race. Stuart Neumann now occupies it, presumably wondering how.

AT A GLANCE

ROUND OF THE DAY  
Henry MELLER (-5)

TROPHY LEAD  
Gregg WILLIAMS, 9 ahead

GREEN JACKET LEAD  
David MULLIN, 5 ahead

ROUND NET VP  
HM -5 | DM -1 | SN -1 | GW 0 | JB 0  
ROUND GROSS  
DM +17 | HM +17 | JB +21 | SN +21 | GW +32

AFTER R2 • TROPHY  
GW -12 | JB -3 | DM -2 | HM +2 | SN +3  
AFTER R2 • GREEN JACKET  
DM +34 | JB +39 | HM +46 | SN +47 | GW +52

DAVID MULLIN | STUART NEUMANN

## Mullin Extends Lead While Spoon Flips

Gregg Williams's cushion at the top proved undentable, but the placings shuffled hard at both ends of the field behind him.

David Mullin tightened his grip on the Green Jacket at Costa Brava. He closed round two with three straight pars from 15 to 17. The stretch cost him nothing in gross terms and gained three shots to par on his handicap line. Tidy, unhurried, and faintly insulting to everyone else on the property.

His Jacket lead went from one shot to five. Gregg Williams, elsewhere, held the top of the Trophy standings with the gap there unchanged at nine.

At the other end of the table, the Wooden Spoon changed hands. Stuart Neumann bogeyed the par-4 12th, one of the harder holes on the course, and

that was sufficient to deposit him at the very bottom, displacing Henry Meller. The margin is thin. Just one shot back to the next player. Neumann could climb straight out of the cellar in round three. For Mullin, the direction of travel looks rather more settled.

GREGG WILLIAMS

## Williams Wobbles But The Lead Holds

A quadruple bogey at the 7th began a spell of scoring that would have unsettled anyone without a nine-shot lead already banked.

Gregg Williams arrived at Club de Golf Costa Brava on 22 September 2013 leading the TEG Trophy. An opening round of net -12 had earned him the privilege. Round 2 examined the claim in some detail.

The front nine was a procession of bogeys, interrupted only by a quadruple bogey at the 7th, the hardest hole on the course. By the turn he was

leaking shots in every direction. He continued, throughout, to carry himself like the leader of a golf tournament.

The stretch from the 9th to the 12th read rather better than it looked. Four more bogeys, but with handicap strokes attached they banked him four shots against the field. The relief lasted exactly four holes. From the 13th to the 16th he shed 11

gross shots without recording a single net par. That was the low point of the round, and it was not a close contest.

A birdie at the 17th, the easiest hole, finally broke the run of bogey-or-worse. The swing from Round 1 to Round 2 was 12 shots. His overnight cushion absorbed all of it without complaint. He still led the Trophy, the gap unchanged at nine.

RECORDS & PERSONAL BESTS

## Notable achievements: TEG 6, Round 2

PERSONAL BESTS

- Henry Meller posts a personal-best round: -5
- Henry Meller posts a personal-best Gross round: +17